Understanding mental health

England support routes

What does it mean?

Everyone has mental health, just as everyone has physical health. It affects how we think, feel, cope and connect with other people. It can change with our experiences and circumstances.

Difficulties can look different

Someone may feel anxious, low, overwhelmed or unable to sleep. Some people live with conditions such as depression, OCD or bipolar disorder. You cannot tell how someone feels just by looking at them.

What support is available?

A GP can help you understand what is happening and discuss support. This may include talking therapies, practical help or medication. Different people need different care. You can ask for help without having a diagnosis.

How can we support each other?

Listen without judging. Ask what would help instead of assuming. Avoid telling someone to "snap out of it". Mental health difficulties are nothing to be ashamed of, and nobody deserves ridicule or discrimination.

Need urgent help?

In England, call NHS 111 and select the mental health option for urgent help. Call 999 or go to A&E if life is at risk or you cannot keep yourself or someone else safe.

Samaritans: 116 123 - free listening support, day or night. Hadamley is not a monitored support or emergency service.

For general information only. Hadamley Information Services provides independently compiled information from publicly available sources. This content is not medical advice and should not be used to diagnose or treat a condition or replace advice from a qualified healthcare professional. Speak to your healthcare team about symptoms, treatment or changes to your health.

Sources and further reading (clickable in the PDF):

NHS mental health
NHS urgent mental health help
Samaritans

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